

Rome's two most brilliant generals, Pompey the Great (106–48 BCE) and Julius Caesar (100–44 BCE). Caesar defeated

have again. A plot was hatched, and Caesar was stabbed to death at a Senate meeting in 44 BCE.

CAESAR WORE A CROWN OF LAUREL LEAVES TO HIDE HIS BALD PATCH!

Pompey and made himself the dictator of Rome—a single ruler with more power than the magistrates. To the proud Romans, Caesar had become too much like a king—the type of leader they never wanted to

The first emperor

Caesar's death solved nothing. Civil war flared up again as other generals fought to take control. Among them was Octavian (63 BCE–14 CE), the great-nephew of Julius Caesar.

In 31 BCE, Octavian defeated his enemies. He was now the sole ruler of Rome. But Octavian knew that the Senate and the Roman people would never accept this. So in 27 BCE, he offered to hand his powers back to the Senate, saying it was his way of bringing peace to the Roman world.

It was a clever move and the turning point in Rome's history. The Senate accepted Octavian's offer but still left him with immense power. He was given a new name, Augustus, which meant the "revered one." He had become the first emperor.



AFTER DEFEATING POMPEY, JULIUS CAESAR (LEFT) MADE HIMSELF THE SOLE RULER OF ROME, BUT HE MADE MANY ENEMIES BY ACTING LIKE A KING.